Life Force

Campbell Smith

DSDN244

Life Force;

the vital principle or force within all living things.

Through my essay I have captured photos from two very different landscapes, both featuring flowing water. The first is Island Bay, the place where my Grandfather grew up, and a spot often my flatmate and I'll drive to get out of the house, the second is Trelissick Park, an off-leash dog park I often walk dog's through for work, but also a place I enjoy going to for tramping due to the stream that runs the whole length.

. Through these photographs I have attempted to try capture my relationship with water, the chaos, the calm, the isolation, and the beauty of water in its flowing forms.



I was born into a family who love the water, it's a trait we all share and something we've bonded with. My Grandfather was a sailor by hobby, my aunts and mother all learnt to sail, my cousins learnt to sail, and so did I. Growing up whenever I was upset, stressed, or even just happy, we'd go to the beach, or the pool, this is something I have carried through into adulthood. Whenever I feel the stress from University I have gone out to the water.







But the more time I have spent here the more I have found water in different places, and learnt to appreciate it's nuances.



After moving to Wellington for the first time I felt like I'd lost this lifeline, the beaches here aren't clear, with smooth sand like I'd experienced driving up North every summer.



Over this year I and my family have gone through more trials and tribulations than I'd ever thought I could withstand, many of these feeling to culminate in my grandfather's passing in August. My grandfather was a special man, he was very ahead of his time ideologically, and in my childhood shared with me his film camera collection and love of photography. It's during my childhood he developed early stages of dementia, but one thing consistent throughout his years was the stack of national geographic books beside his chair, that often he'd flick through and show to us what sights he still wanted to see and where he wanted to travel.

Many of them were of the sea.





















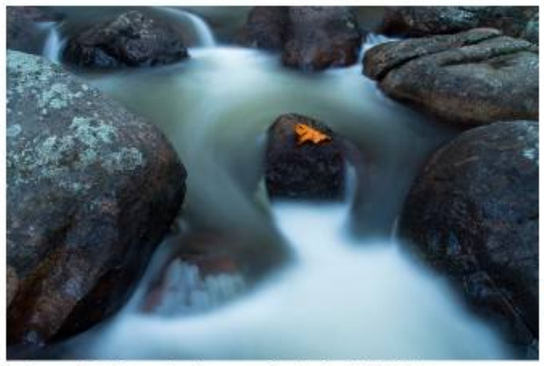


Precedents

Dustin Lefevre



Lefevre, D. 'Steadfast #1' (2015)



Lefevre, D. 'Alone in Autumn Splendor' (2014)



Lefevre, D. 'Breaking' (2015)

Dustin Lefevre is a Utah based photographer, focusing on landscapes in this area and on his travels.

Lefevre's composition is interesting to me, through his images he places water as the main focus, largely using a slow shutter speed to create water that seems continious. Lefevre through his composition is able to use water to focus on everything around it, and return the viewers eye back to it.

Whilst I enjoy the appearance of water in his photographs, I prefer the look of a fast shutter speed which captures the single moment rather than the longer movement.

Lefevre, D. 'Kanarraville Creek #2' (2015)

Accessed from https://dustin-lefevre.pixels.com/

Micheal Shainblum



Shainblum, M. 'San Francisco Seascape Photography' (2016)

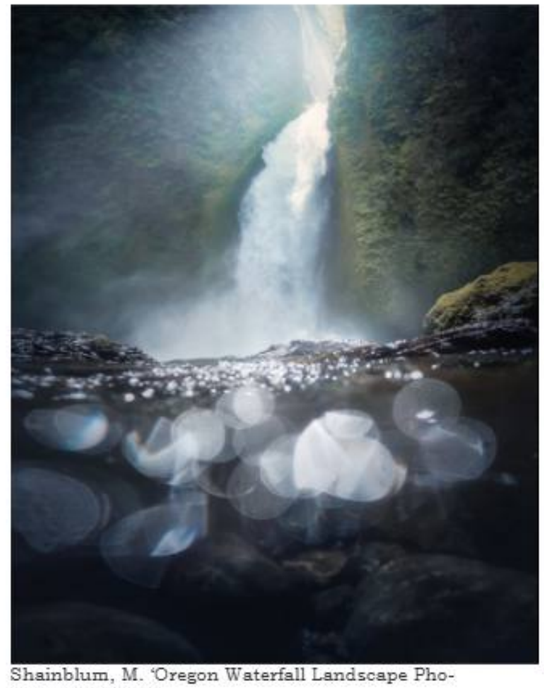
Micheal Shainblum is a California based photographer, he shares many of his techniques, and ideas on his youtube channel.

Shainblum's composition is interesting, using varying angles he changes the focus of the images, all celebrating and highlight water and it's movement.

Whilst I don't enjoy the look of long exposure for water, I do enjoy the was Shainblum uses it, seemingly longer but not to long allowing for a lot of the detail to remain.



Shainblum, M. 'Washington Waterfall Landscape Photography' (2014)



Shainblum, M. 'Oregon Waterfall Landscape Photography' (2017)

Accessed from https://shainblumphoto.com/

Test Shoot №1

Test Shoot №2



























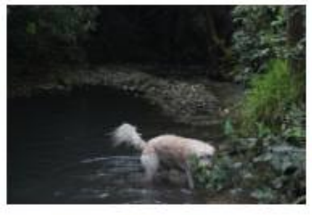


















Development

From the start of the project I knew I wanted to photograph Island Bay, this was due to the recent passing of my Grandfather, and having gone through many of his old photo slides with my mother, which included a handful from his childhood in Wellington.

Intially I played with the idea of shooting on film as a nod to him, but realised with the little time I had avaliable to drive to locations that development time ontop of, as well as aditional cost, would make it a more difficult factor.

I also played with the idea of includng a piece of myself in each photograph, but by the time I came round to shooting in Trelissick park I felt disingaged with the focus, instead just wanting to let the water in the photos speak for itself.

Timeline;

9th-15th
- Test Shoots on Concepts
- Research into Precidents and Aesthetics

16th-22nd
- Refined shoot on choosen topic
- Concept is finalised

23rd-29th
- Final Shoot
- Research into precidents is complete
- Editing and Layout is started

30th-4th
- Essay format is complete
- Submission Ready by 3rd

Final Photos

